

SOCIAL MINISTRIES

Rs 1,00,000 crore a year on poverty alleviation alone. There is intent but rarely delivery.

KUMARI SELJA

Minister of Housing & Urban Poverty Alleviation and Minister of Tourism

Right Up Front

Both the urban and urbane face of the Government, she is equally at ease talking up the big-ticket Rajiv Awas Yojana for a slum-free India as she is inaugurating hotels for the Commonwealth Games. But she has no time to think big about the \$100-billion tourism industry.

Next Big Thing

A model real estate Act to be used by states to draft their legislation in a hotly contested domain.

▼ 34%

MALLIKARJUN KHARGE

Minister of Labour and Employment

Root Cause

The veteran trade unionist from Gulbarga has given a new lease of life to a two-decade-old legislation bringing workers closer to boardrooms, starting with public sector units.

Big Miss

Even after the Left lost its clout, he was unable to push crucial reforms.

▼ 32%

KAPIL SIBAL

Minister of Human Resource Development

Man in a Hurry

Act now, implement later. That's been Sibal's mantra in a whirlwind of a year where he's tried to be all things to all constituents. So if the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act (RTE) satisfies the proponents of social justice, the Foreign Education Institution (Regulation of Entry and Operations) Bill sets the stage for foreign universities to get a level playing field, and the proposed PPP model for 2,500 model schools encourages corporate involvement. But his biggest of Big Ideas may well remain on statute books, if he is unable to enthuse states and insist that they part with the funds needed to match his grand vision for the future.

Achievements

I Freeing the portfolio from ideological oscillation and placing education slam bang in the centre of the nation's mindspace.

I Heralding a consultative style of working through roundtables.

Failures

I Not thinking every reform through, whether it is the RTE Act or the draft National Commission for Higher Education Bill.

I Inability to convince the seven laggard states to step up for RTE.

▼ 62%

What Is To Be Done?

About his run-away tongue? Whether it is IIT eligibility or a uniform school-leaving examination for Class XII, Sibal says and retracts almost in the same breath.

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